Public and National Holidays 2026

Holiday Calendar for Data Axle India for the Period 1 January 2026 to 31 December 2026

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Policy Owner: Head of People Operations, India (Priya Deshmukh)
Approved By: Managing Director, India (Rohan Kulkarni)
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Applies To: All employees of Data Axle India Private Limited at the Pune and Bengaluru offices
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1. Introduction

This document lists the paid holidays observed by Data Axle India Private Limited during the calendar year 2026, from 1 January 2026 to 31 December 2026. The calendar has been prepared with reference to the national holidays of India, the public holidays notified by the Government of Maharashtra for Pune district, and the festivals most widely observed by employees. It was approved by the Managing Director, India on 28 November 2025 and published on Axle Connect on 1 December 2025. This document should be read together with the Leave Policy (DA-IN-HR-003) and the Company Policies (DA-IN-POL-001).

2. Structure of the Holiday Calendar

Employees are entitled to a total of 14 paid holidays in 2026. These comprise 12 Fixed Holidays, which are observed by the entire Company and on which all offices remain closed, and 2 Restricted Holidays, which each employee chooses from the list of optional holidays in Section 4. The three national holidays of India, namely Republic Day, Independence Day and Gandhi Jayanti, are always Fixed Holidays. Saturdays and Sundays are weekly offs for all employees other than those on an approved shift roster, and are not counted as holidays.

3. Fixed Holidays for 2026

The following 12 holidays are observed by all employees of Data Axle India in 2026. Both the Pune and Bengaluru offices follow the same list so that teams working across the two locations remain aligned.

1. **Thursday, 1 January 2026** - New Year's Day
2. **Monday, 26 January 2026** - Republic Day (National Holiday)
3. **Thursday, 19 February 2026** - Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Jayanti
4. **Wednesday, 4 March 2026** - Holi (Dhulivandan)
5. **Thursday, 19 March 2026** - Gudi Padwa (Marathi New Year)
6. **Friday, 1 May 2026** - Maharashtra Day and International Labour Day
7. **Saturday, 15 August 2026** - Independence Day (National Holiday)
8. **Monday, 14 September 2026** - Ganesh Chaturthi
9. **Friday, 2 October 2026** - Gandhi Jayanti (National Holiday)
10. **Tuesday, 20 October 2026** - Dussehra (Vijayadashami)
11. **Monday, 9 November 2026** - Diwali (Balipratipada / Diwali Padwa)
12. **Friday, 25 December 2026** - Christmas Day

Independence Day falls on a Saturday in 2026. In accordance with the Company's practice, no substitute holiday is declared when a Fixed Holiday falls on a weekly off. Diwali Laxmi Pujan falls on Sunday, 8 November 2026, and the Company therefore observes the following day, Balipratipada, as the Diwali holiday. Buddha Purnima also falls on Friday, 1 May 2026 and is covered by the Maharashtra Day holiday. As a result, 11 of the 12 Fixed Holidays fall on working days, and the Company has 250 working days in 2026 before Restricted Holidays and individual leave are taken into account.

4. Restricted Holidays for 2026

Each employee may choose any 2 of the following optional holidays. The choice must be recorded in Axle Connect by 31 January 2026, or within 30 days of joining for employees who join during the year. Employees who join on or after 1 October 2026 are entitled to 1 Restricted Holiday for the year. The selection may be changed once during the year, provided the change is made at least 7 calendar days before the earlier of the two dates involved and neither date has already been availed. Unused Restricted Holidays lapse on 31 December 2026 and are not carried forward or encashed.

1. **Wednesday, 14 January 2026** - Makar Sankranti
2. **Friday, 20 March 2026** - Eid-ul-Fitr (Ramzan Eid)
3. **Thursday, 26 March 2026** - Ram Navami
4. **Tuesday, 31 March 2026** - Mahavir Jayanti
5. **Friday, 3 April 2026** - Good Friday
6. **Tuesday, 14 April 2026** - Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Jayanti
7. **Wednesday, 27 May 2026** - Bakri Eid (Eid-ul-Adha)
8. **Friday, 26 June 2026** - Muharram (Ashura)
9. **Friday, 28 August 2026** - Raksha Bandhan
10. **Friday, 4 September 2026** - Janmashtami
11. **Friday, 25 September 2026** - Anant Chaturdashi (Ganesh Visarjan)
12. **Tuesday, 10 November 2026** - Bhau Beej (Bhai Dooj)
13. **Tuesday, 24 November 2026** - Guru Nanak Jayanti

The dates of Eid-ul-Fitr, Bakri Eid and Muharram depend on the sighting of the moon and may shift by one day. If the Government of Maharashtra notifies a different date, the Company will observe the notified date and update Axle Connect accordingly; an employee who has selected the holiday is not required to re-apply.

5. Rules Governing Holidays

5.1 Holidays Adjoining Leave

A Fixed Holiday or a selected Restricted Holiday that falls immediately before or after a period of leave is not counted as leave. A Fixed Holiday that falls between two days of Earned Leave is counted as Earned Leave under the sandwich rule described in the Leave Policy; the sandwich rule does not apply to Casual Leave, and applies to Sick Leave only where the certified absence exceeds 5 working days.

5.2 Working on a Holiday

Employees are not expected to work on a Fixed Holiday. Where a client deliverable or production support requirement makes it necessary, the department head must approve the requirement in writing in advance. An employee at any level who works for at least 4 hours on a Fixed Holiday or on a selected Restricted Holiday earns one compensatory day off, which must be recorded by the manager in Axle Connect within 7 days of the holiday and availed within 60 calendar days of the holiday worked. Compensatory off cannot be carried beyond 60 days, encashed or converted into any type of leave.

5.3 Shift and Client-Aligned Teams

Teams rostered to support clients in the United States may be required to follow a client-aligned holiday schedule agreed in the statement of work. Such teams observe the three national holidays of India as Fixed Holidays in all cases. Any other Fixed Holiday on which a team is rostered to work is converted into a compensatory day off under Section 5.2, and the team's roster for the year is published in Axle Connect by 15 January 2026.

5.4 Office Closure and Facilities

On Fixed Holidays the Pune and Bengaluru offices are closed, the cafeteria does not operate and building access is limited to employees who hold written approval under Section 5.2. The IT Service Desk operates on a reduced on-call basis on holidays and can be reached through the emergency support line published on Axle Connect. Employee transport for approved shifts continues to operate on holidays.

5.5 Location Transfers and New Joiners

Employees who transfer between the Pune and Bengaluru offices during the year follow the same Fixed Holiday list and retain their Restricted Holiday selection. New joiners are entitled to all Fixed Holidays falling on or after their date of joining. Restricted Holiday entitlement for new joiners is described in Section 4.

6. Long Weekends in 2026

For the convenience of employees planning their Earned Leave, the following Fixed Holidays create long weekends in 2026 without any additional leave: Republic Day on Monday, 26 January; Maharashtra Day on Friday, 1 May; Gandhi Jayanti on Friday, 2 October; Diwali on Monday, 9 November; and Christmas on Friday, 25 December. Employees who select Good Friday, 3 April as a Restricted Holiday also gain a long weekend. Planned Earned Leave adjoining these dates is subject to the notice periods and team cover requirements described in the Leave Policy, and managers are encouraged to confirm such requests early.

7. Publication and Queries

This calendar is published on Axle Connect and displayed at the reception of each office. The calendar for 2027 will be published by 1 December 2026. Questions regarding this document may be sent to people.india@data-axle.in.